

COAT, DOUBLET, AND HOSE

SAXONY ENSEMBLE

This unique and extraordinary set of mid-16th-century clothes belonged to Maurice, Elector of Saxony from 1547 to 1553. It is the most complete – and oldest surviving – example of real fashion from the period. The princely ensemble comprises a short, round, pleated coat with puffed and hanging sleeves, a satin doublet, puffed and slashed trunk-hose, and chamois or suede hose. Yellow silks accented with black velvet are an extravagant reflection of the heraldic colours of the Saxon state. Using bands of fabric in this way to decorate clothing was fashionable throughout the 16th century. The almost square, imposing silhouette matches exactly with the aristocratic masculine fashions seen in many paintings of the time.



△ TRUNK-HOSE

The trunk-hose are made of panes of silk velvet on the bias, slashed diagonally so the cuts appear straight. Each strip is bound in satin. Inside, pieces of satin are crumpled down to give the fashionable puffed effect.